

Readme file for

Moderating Political Extremism: Single Round vs Runoff Elections under Plurality Rule

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Data Description

The two data files included in the "dataset" folder contain all the variables used in the empirical analysis of this article. More specifically:

- the "dual_ballot_replication.dta" dataset contains the relevant variables for the period in which the reform was in place (1993-2000).
- "dual_ballot_falsification.dta" contains data related to the pre treatment period, from 1985 onwards. They are used to implement the falsification test reported in Table 2.

Each of the main variables in the datasets can be identified by appropriate labels in English. Please refer to the article for a more detailed description of how they were constructed.

Data sources

The main dataset contains variables on the Italian Municipalities coming from different sources:

- Data on population (1991 and 2001 Census) and other features of the municipality (per capita income, geographic location and demographic features) *Source: ANCI - Associazione Nazionale Comuni Italiani*
- Political variables at the city level such as number of candidates for Mayor, vote shares, voter turnout, number of council lists. *Source: Statistical office of the Italian Ministry of Internal Affairs.*
- Data on the municipal tax on business property. *Source: Italian Ministry of Internal Affairs*

Replication of the main results

Statistical Software: *Stata 13*

To replicate the main results of the paper, simply run the code contained in the "replication.do" file. The required packages are installed at the beginning of the do file. Results are stored in the "output" folder, automatically created in the process. Each subfolder refers to a table or figure in the paper.